

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

May Reilly Parker

OCCUPATION

Homemaker

BASE

New York City

HEIGHT 5 ft 5 in**WEIGHT** 110 lbs**EYES** Blue**HAIR** White**FIRST APPEARANCE:**

Amazing Fantasy #15

(August 1962)

PARKER, AUNT MAY

It may not have always been easy, but May Parker's life has certainly been eventful. Following a difficult childhood, May found love with Ben Parker, their marriage being further enriched when they became guardians to Ben's nephew, Peter. Sadly, their life together ended prematurely when Ben was shot dead by a burglar. The years that followed would be testing.

Amazing cook, (particularly her corn beef hash) and formidable personality—even Wolverine is afraid of her.



Happening upon Peter's ragged Spider-Man costume, May finally realised the startling truth about her nephew.

After Peter became SPIDER-MAN, he kept his secret identity from her for fear of upsetting her health. She learned it at one point, but she has now forgotten. An assassin hired by the KINGPIN shot May after Spider-Man revealed his identity to the world during the

Civil War (see pp.84–5).



Spider-Man intervened just in time to prevent Dr. Octopus from marrying May.

To save her life, Peter and his wife Mary Jane Watson gave up their entire marriage to MEPHISTO, who wiped it—and everyone's memory of Peter's secret—from existence. Restored to health, she now volunteers at a homeless shelter. **AD, MF**

PARKER, UNCLE BEN

Although never rich, his wisdom and fair-mindedness earned Ben Parker the respect of everyone he met. A carnival barker in his youth, Ben grew up in the same neighbourhood as May Reilly, for whom he harbored deep feelings. Love did not come easily to the pair, though—

Ben was forced to compete for May's affections with the glamorous Johnny Jerome. It was only when May learnt that Johnny was a petty crook that she finally accepted Ben into her life.

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Benjamin Parker

OCCUPATION

Retired

BASE

New York City

HEIGHT 5 ft 9 in**WEIGHT** 175 lbs**EYES** Blue**HAIR** White**FIRST APPEARANCE**

Amazing Fantasy #15

(August 1962)

Wisdom, charisma, integrity, strength of personality and high moral standards.

Following his brother's death, Ben felt honor bound to raise his nephew, Peter, as his very own.



Throughout their time together, Ben and May were to struggle financially, and these monetary straits only worsened when they adopted Ben's nephew, Peter, as their own. In spite of these pressures, however, Peter brought considerable joy into their lives. Tragically that joy would be cut short, when Ben was killed by a burglar's bullet.

The memory of his kindly uncle inspired Peter to use his newfound spider powers to do good in the world, and so Ben Parker's spirit lives on. **AD**



Ben's tragic murder continues to inspire Peter Parker, even to this day.